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WEAVERS MANIFESTO CRIES FOR RESPECT, SUPPORT FOR PHILIPPINE WEAVES, DENOUNCES MACHINE REPLICAS, PRINTED SUBSTITUTES

The growing popularity of traditional handloom-woven textiles has placed Filipino weavers at a critical crossroads. Their designs, heritage, and livelihoods are increasingly threatened not only by printed and machine-made replicas but also by unfair market access, lack of intellectual property protection, and limited recognition of their rights as artists, cultural bearers, and workers. While counterfeit fabrics dilute authenticity and deceive consumers, deeper challenges persist.

Weavers struggle to reach inclusive markets, secure fair compensation, and pass down their craft to future generations. These shared concerns have prompted weaving communities across the country to unite and assert their rights to livelihood, cultural identity, and a rightful place in the nation’s textile value chain.

In response to this growing concern, the Department of Science and Technology, Philippine Textile Research Institute (DOST PTRI),

➔ (Sundan sa pahina 2)



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RECTO: HUMAN SECURITY MUST BE CENTRAL TO NATIONAL SECURITY

Executive Secretary Ralph G. Recto has underscored that human security must be central to the Philippines’ national security, saying that real security lies in safeguarding everything that allows Filipino families to live with dignity and hope.

In his speech at National Security Summit 2025, Executive Secretary Recto said national security must be defined by the everyday issues that affect the lives of Filipino families. “It is food that is affordable. Power that stays on. A job that pays enough. Truth in our newsfeeds. Trust in our institutions,” he said. “Because security is more than the absence of a shooting war. It means the presence of opportunity,” he added. In line with this, the Executive Secretary commended the National Security Council (NSC) for aligning the National Security Strategy (NSS) 2024 with the Philippine Development Plan (PDP), which addresses every thread of Filipino

➔ (Sundan sa pahina 2)

DOST Ilocos Region Deepens its Advocacy for a VAW-Free Philippines Through “Orange your Icon” Event

Moving the region closer to a truly VAW-free community, the Department of Science and Technology Ilocos Region (DOST Ilocos Region) once again showed its strong and continued support for the nationwide advocacy to End Violence Against Women (VAW) as it joined the Department of Tourism Region 1 for this year’s “Orange Your Icon” activity under the 18-Day Campaign to End VAW. Held at the Tomb of the Unknown Soldier in Barangay Madayegdeg, City of San Fernando, La Union, the

➔ (Sundan sa pahina 3)



DOST Region 02 Upskills S&T Pen Videography to Boost Scicomm

The Department of Science and Technology (DOST) Region 02 strengthened its science communication initiatives as it conducted Science That Sees: A Workshop on Videography for SciTech Storytelling. The workshop was held from December 11-12, 2025, at NGN Hotel focused on elevating the quality and consistency of visual outputs used in field documentation, project reporting, and public information materials, emphasizing the growing role of videography in evidence-based science communication. Participants took part in the session facilitated by videography resource speaker Sir John Lewie Reyes, an Information Officer from the Cagayan State University (CSU) who discussed the fundamental elements of videography, including framing, camera angles, shot types, camera movement, and visual continuity. Reyes emphasized that videography plays a critical role in science communication by effectively capturing processes, transformations, and sequences that static images alone cannot fully convey, particularly in documenting scientific interventions and community-based projects. He also highlighted ethical considerations in filming activities and community beneficiaries, stressing the impor-

tance of accuracy, consent, and proper representation in science, technology, and innovation (STI) documentation. A storyboarding session guided participants in structuring their visual narratives prior to filming. Participants identified key messages, organized sequences, selected appropriate angles, and developed shot lists for their planned videos. This was followed by an editing workshop where participants assembled video clips, refined pacing, and incorporated narration and graphics to enhance clarity and narrative cohesion. As the culminating activity, participants were grouped into four teams, each tasked to produce a two- to three-minute video in different genres, incorporating the videography fundamentals discussed during the workshop. The final outputs demonstrated improved application of framing, sequencing, storytelling, and ethical documentation. The groups presented their videos, showcasing enhanced competencies in visual sequencing, explanation, and narrative flow. The workshop forms part of DOST Region 02's ongoing efforts to standardize documentation practices and strengthen visual storytelling for programs such as SETUP, CEST, Smart and Sustainable Communities, and other STI initiatives.

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WEAVERS MANIFESTO CRIES FOR RESPECT, SUPPORT FOR PHILIPPINE WEAVES... MULA PAHINA 1



consolidated the weavers' insights and thoughts through the Weavers Manifesto during the 1st Philippine Handloom Weaving Festival held at Robinsons Ilocos in Ilocos Norte on 22 November 2025 as part of the National Science, Technology and Innovation Week. The signing was led by Dr. Julius Leaño Jr., Director of DOST PTRI, and the delegation of more than 120 weavers from over 40 weaving communities across the country. It was witnessed by DOST Ilocos Region Director, Dr. Tereista Tabaog and Assistant Secretary Anna Carmela V. Remigio, Presidential Assistant for Northern Luzon. The DOST-PTRI and the weavers initially conducted a focused group discussion (FGD) that raised the concerns and needs of weaving communities across the country. The resulting Weavers' Manifesto captured the 8 main and critical issues raised during the FGD. The signatories call for the following: Opposition to the widespread use of counterfeit handwoven textiles and machine-made woven replicas as substitutes for the authentic handwoven fabrics of the Philippines. (Pagtutol sa malawakang paggamit ng mga pek-eng hinabing tela at mga hinabing replika na gawa ng mga makina bilang panghalip sa mga tunay na habing-kamay ng Pilipinas.) Use of handwoven textiles for the uniforms and attire of government employees and students. (Paggamit sa mga hinabing tela para sa uniporme at kasuotan ng

mga kawani ng pamahalaan at mga mag-aaral.) Strong opposition to the use of woven textile designs in sublimation printing and in printed fabrics being sold as if they were handloom woven. (Mariing pagtutol sa paggamit ng mga disenyo ng hinabing tela bilang disenyo sa sublimation printing at sa mga printed na tela binebenta bilang hinahabing tela.) Expanded access for weavers to cotton and natural textile fiber-based yarns. (Mas pinalawak na akses ng mga manghahabi sa cotton at natural textile fiber-based yarns.) Broader access to training programs to prepare the next generations of weavers and to promote knowledge about the art and science of weaving, especially among the youth. (Pinalawak na akses sa mga programa sa pagsasanay upang maihanda ang mga sumusunod na henerasyon ng mga manghahabi at pagpapalaganap ng kaalaman ukol sa sining at agham ng paghahabi lalo na sa mga kabataan.) Unification of all weavers across the Philippines into an organized group. (Pagbubuklod ng lahat ng mga manghahabi sa buong pilipinas bilang isang organisadong grupo.) Strengthening policies for the development of the weaving sector and for the protection of intellectual property and the creations of weavers and their respective communities. (Pagpapagiging ng mga polisiya para sa pagpapaunlad ng larangan at pagprotekta sa yamang-isip at mga likha ng manghahabi at ng kanilang gru-

pong kinabibilangan.) Respect for the rights and recognition of weavers, especially women whose livelihoods depend on this craft. (Paggalang sa mga karapatan at pagpapahalaga sa mga manghahabi lalo na ang mga kababaihang nakabatay ang kabuhayan sa larangang ito.) As the Weavers' Manifesto underlines the importance of keeping weaving traditions alive for cultural and economic advancement of weavers, a testimony came from Marlyn Muyana of the Baraclarayan Weavers Association of Iloilo who shared how their community's weaving center contributes to their community advancement, "Before the weaving center was established, our barangay was considered one of the poorest in the municipality. Many families struggled to meet daily needs, and sending children to school felt like an impossible dream. But through hard work, unity, and commitment, the weaving center became our turning point. Today, we are proud to say that we have no out-of-school youth in our community. Almost all our students now have the chance to pursue higher education in colleges and universities." The said Manifesto is also in line with the advocacy raised by Dr. Leaño, Jr., during the opening ceremony of the festival, when for the first time he publicly called on the public and said, "Sana po 'wag na kayong bumili ng fake handloom woven fabrics...because you are not just depriving them of their livelihood. You are depriving them

of their culture. You are depriving them of their identity. And most importantly, you are depriving them of their future." The Philippine Handloom Weaving Festival generated over ₱2 million in gross sales of handloom woven products from over 120 participating weavers from more than 40 weaving communities representing various regions across the country. A total of 600 kilograms of cotton yarns was also distributed to the weavers as part of the CottonPH Weaving Movement, a program that aims to boost local handloom weaving, reduce dependency on imported yarns, and promote sustainability by providing weavers with locally spun quality yarns. This is the first massive distribution of yarns that awaits feedback on the weavability and the overall transitioning journey that the weavers will undergo in weaving Philippine cotton yarns. Ilocos Norte will also be able to spin and produce cotton yarns for Northern Luzon after the inauguration of the facility last 20 November in Vintar, Ilocos Norte, during the duration of the Festival. The four-day festival attracted over 1,000 participants in all its activities. The 1st Philippine Handloom Weaving Festival is a collaboration of the Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte, Ilocos Norte Tourism, Cebu Pacific Air, Robinsons Ilocos, and the Local Government of Taguig City, which is the host city of the Philippine Handloom Weaving Center

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# RECTO: HUMAN SECURIT... MULA PAHINA 1



life—from farmers facing climate uncertainty, to soldiers guarding frontiers, to teachers shaping young minds against disinformation. To secure the Filipino people’s future, the Executive Secretary highlighted that the Marcos Jr. administration is strengthening food security, expanding universal healthcare, and investing in quality education and workforce development. “For our greatest asset—our greatest defense—is the empowered, enlightened, engaged and educated Filipino people,” he said. Restoring Public Trust Executive Secretary Recto also stressed that weak governance and institutional challenges—including corruption, misuse of public funds, and lack of transparency—pose serious risks to national security. “This is why we are pushing for good governance reforms—finally pursuing an anti-political dynasty bill, reforming the party list system, and giving public access to government expenditures,” he said.

“For building stronger and more transparent institutions is the nation’s sturdiest security defense,” he added. He also highlighted the administration’s commitment to fiscal discipline and maintaining a disciplined national budget focused on quality spending to ensure that public funds are directed to programs that genuinely benefit the Filipino people. To address multiple challenges the country is facing today, the Executive Secretary emphasized the need for strategic synergy across all sectors, including the uniformed forces, policy leaders, academics, civil society, industry, and local communities. He said that true national security requires “a government that moves as one, an economy that is strong and felt by every household, and a future defended by all.” In closing, he urged all stakeholders to view the Summit as a renewed commitment—not just to protect the State, but to safeguard the hopes and dreams of every Filipino family.

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# DOST Ilocos Region Deepens its Advocacy for a VAW-Free Philippines... Mula pahina 1



gathering brought together regional agencies and community leaders united by one message ‘every woman deserves safety, respect, and a life free from violence.’ Under the leadership of Regional Director Terecita A. Tabaog, who also serves as Chairperson of the Regional Gender and Development Committee (RGADC) Region 1, DOST Ilocos Region continues to push forward programs and initiatives that empower and protect women and children. Her guidance reflects the Department’s belief that building safer communities goes hand in hand with promoting science, technology, and innovation. During the activity, DOST Ilocos Region participated in the Bougainvillea Planting—a simple yet powerful symbol of resilience, hope, and the shared vision for a violence-free community. The event also featured the lighting of

orange icons around the monument, serving as a reminder that awareness and collective action are essential in ending gender-based violence. Assistant Regional Director Raquel M. Espiritu, who represented Dr. Tabaog, delivered the Department’s message of support. She emphasized that the 18-Day Campaign is not just a yearly observance but a year-round, day-to-day commitment that everyone must take part in. She shared that DOST Ilocos Region remains dedicated to promoting safety, equality, and empowerment—values that continue to guide the Department in its community engagements and advocacy efforts. Through consistent action, strong partnerships, and genuine compassion, DOST Ilocos Region stands firm in helping build a Region 1 where women and children are empowered.

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# SHOWBLITZ By: Charlene Mae

## Alexa Miro, ‘di pa pinapalitan si Cong. Sandro?!



Ang gaang panoorin ng pelikulang Rekonek. May aral, masya, at pang-Pasko talaga. Simple lang ang story, ganundin ang mensahe pero may aray sa puso. Na ang isa sa mga bida ay si Alexa Miro na napansin ang character sa pelikula. Ginanap ang grand premiere night ng pelikula the other night. Ang usap-usap ng isa sa official entries ng Metro Manila Film Festival (MMFF) 2025 sa Trinoma. Anyway, single ngayon si Alexa. Wala pa ulit siyang nakakarelasyon after Cong. Sandro Marcos. So malamig ba ang Pasko niya? “Okey naman ang Christmas natin, siyempre spending it with our own family, and with our fellow Filipinos,” chika niya sa mga kausap na writer. At happy raw siya sa pagiging single.

“Mas tahi-mik na ngayon!” sagot niya sabay tawa sa mga kaharap na writer. Sa totoo lang, wala namang official statement kumbaga sa naging relasyon nila ng anak nina Pangulong Bongbong Marcos at FL Liza. Pero common knowledge naman in and out of showbiz ang relasyon nila noon. Ang usap-usapan, limang taon din silang naging magkarelasyon pero nagtapos this year. Ang kuwento pa may third party diuman na isa ring actress. S a m a n t a l a , pinagbibidahan ang Rekonek nina Gerald Anderson, Charlie Dizon, Bela Padilla, Andrea Brillantes, Gloria Diaz, Carmina Villarroel, Zoren Legaspi, Cassy Legaspi, Mavy Legaspi, Kokoy De Santos, Angel Guardian at Soliman Cruz, at marami pang iba.

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SPORTS NEWS

Team Philippines nabalam ang ratsada

MANILA, Philippines — Pansamantalang nabalam ang ratsada ng Team Philippines nang kumolekta ng tatlong gintong medalya sa 33rd Southeast Asian Games kahapon sa Thailand.

Humataw ng gold medals sina Pinay tennis sensation Alex Eala, Michael Ver Comaling sa men’s modern pentathlon triathle at ang RP Blu Boys sa men’s softball. Winalis ng 20-anyos na si Eala si Mananchaya Samangkaew ng Thailand, 6-1, 6-2, sa finals.

Tinapos ni Eala ang 26 taon na pagkauhaw sa tennis gold ng Pinas.

Pinabagsak naman ng RP Blu Boys ang Singapore, 3-0, para sa pang-siyam na ginto ng mga Pinoy sluggers sa SEA Games.

Nagpatalsik si lefty pitcher Jehanz Maristela Coro ng 17 Singaporean batters sa isang two-hit shutout para sa pagresbak ng Blu Boys sa pagkatalo nila sa Singapore sa 2019 edition na inilaro sa Clark, Pampanga. Humataw ng solo homer si Justine Rosales sa itaas ng first inning at isang two-run single ni Lyonas de Leon sa fourth inning.

Noong Huwebes ay walong gintong medalya ang inangkin ng mga Pinoy athletes sa pangunguna ng pagwalis ng mga triathletes sa tatlong events.

May 42 golds, 59 silvers at 126 bronzes ang Team Philippines at nahulog sa sixth place sa medal standings.

Napasakamay na ng Thailand ang overall championship sa nakuhang 196 golds, 129 silvers at 92 bronzes.

Pangalawa ang Indonesia sa naitalang 80 ginto, 91 pilak at 102 tansong medalya kasunod ang Vietnam (71-72-99), Singapore (48-51-69) at Malaysia (46-49-108) dalawang araw bago ang opisyal na pagtatapos ng biennial event na nagbukas noong Disyembre 9.

Kumana ng pilak si Arian Geralin Carpio sa women’s freestyle -62kg ng wrestling at sina Merry Joy Trupa, Franklin Ferdie Yee, Erika Nicole Burgos at John Patrick Ciron sa mixed duathlon relay event.

May pilak din si Shyra Mae Aranzado sa women’s modern pentathlon triathle at sina chess players Jan Emmanuel Garcia at Paulo Bersamina sa men’s makruk doubles standard event.

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